

Duolingo

GPT-4 deepens the conversation on Duolingo.

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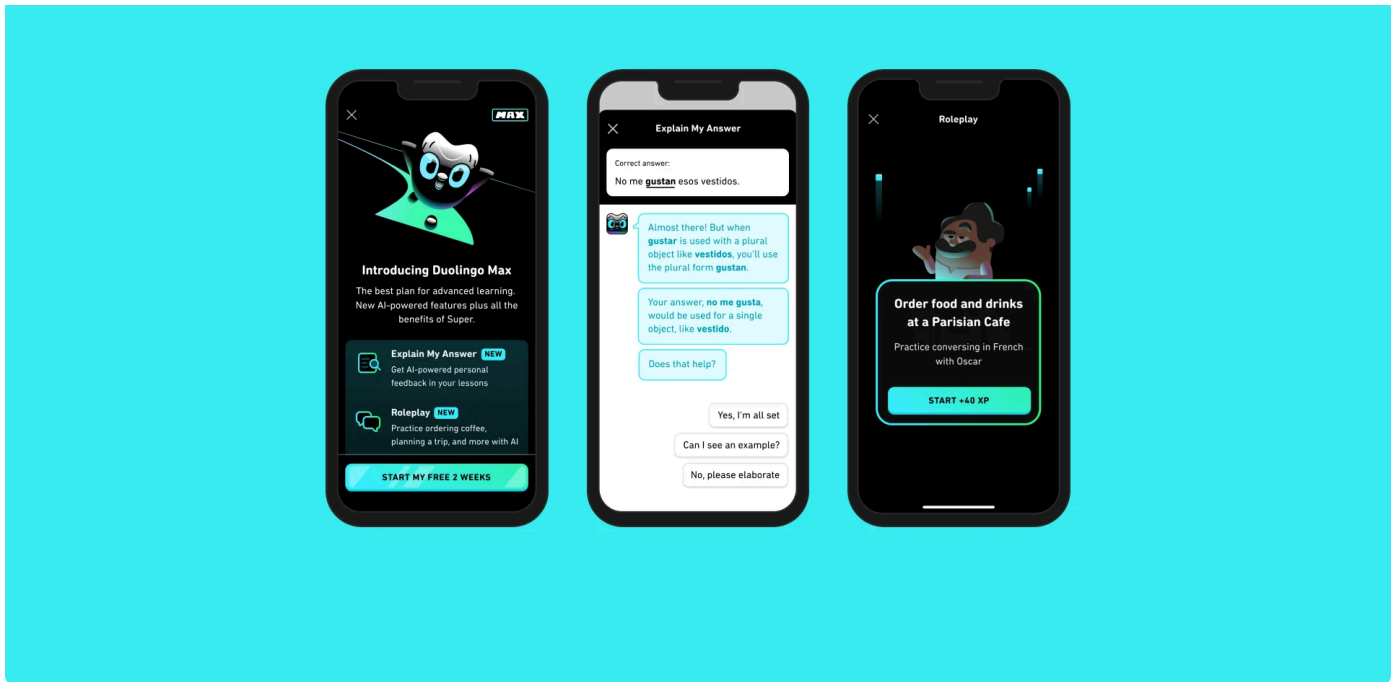
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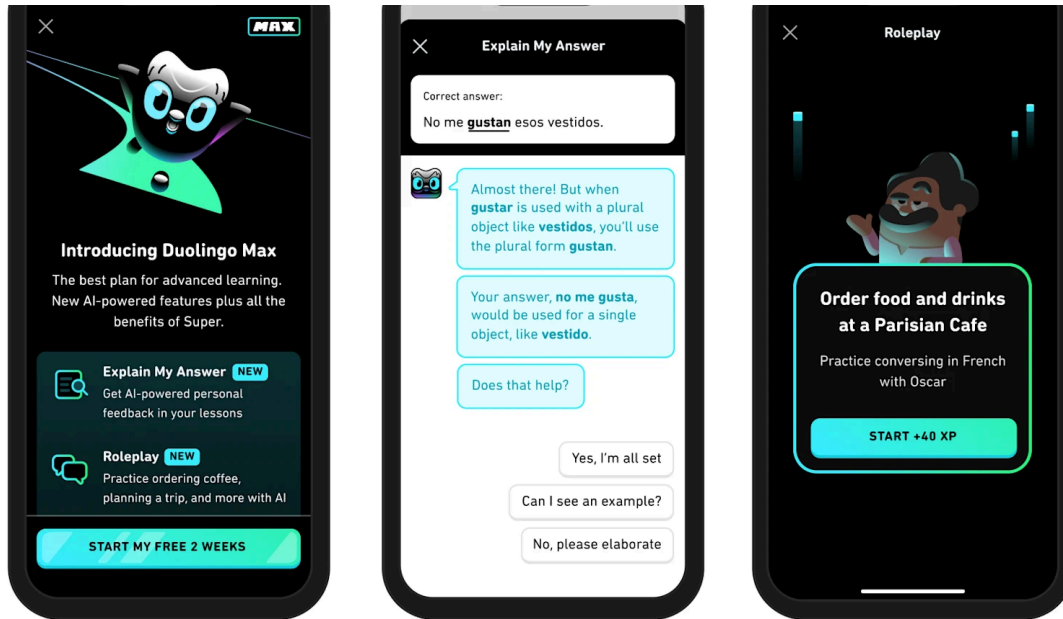
Over 50 million learners rely on Duolingo every month to teach them a second language. With a simple user interface and fun-but-competitive leaderboards, Duolingo supports 40 languages across 100+ courses. Learners advance from simple vocabulary exercises to complicated sentence structures with taps and swipes on their phone.

If a learner wants to advance beyond basic proficiency, it's helpful to understand the rules of grammar. But true proficiency in a language requires conversation, ideally with a native

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Duolingo turned to OpenAI’s GPT-4 to advance the product with two new features: Role Play, an AI conversation partner, and Explain my Answer, which breaks down the rules when you make a mistake, in a new subscription tier called Duolingo Max.

“We wanted AI-powered features that were deeply integrated into the app and leveraged the gamified aspect of Duolingo that our learners love,” says Bodge.

Duolingo is a language learning app that uses AI to help users learn new languages.

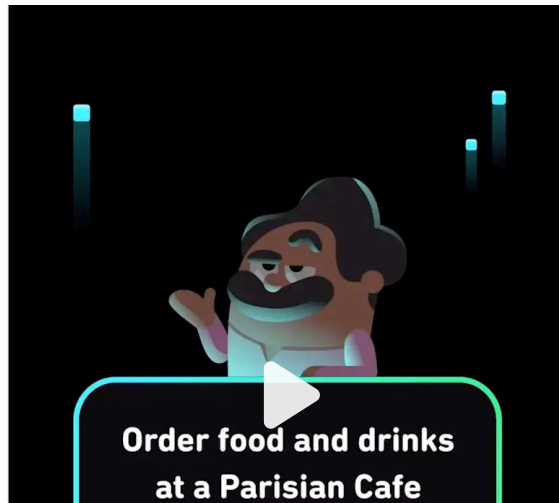
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Edwin Bodge, Principal Product Manager, Duolingo



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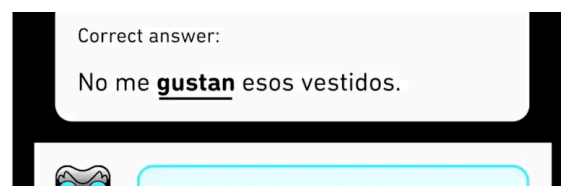
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practice—is more effective than memorizing rules. This posed an interesting challenge to Duolingo.

Many of Duolingo’s learners *want* to learn the explicit rules, and the company has tried to teach them with both pre-written Grammar Tips and artificial intelligence. Even with GPT-3, the implementation was difficult. Teaching grammar requires a specific understanding of the error and why a learner made it. One incorrect term in the explanation could teach the concept incorrectly or leave the user confused and dissatisfied.

“GPT-4 gives us far more confidence in the accuracy of AI responses in *Explain my Answer*,” says Peterson.

With the new features, learners will be able to click “Explain my answer”, and GPT-4 will give an initial response. From there, the learner can return to the lesson, or get further explanation, and GPT-4 can dynamically update. Duolingo will gauge the quality of GPT-4’s responses by how deep the learner needs to go before returning to the lesson.



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The team sees the potential with GPT-4 to provide a more effective and engaging learning experience than ever before, which should improve learning outcomes. In addition, Peterson says the ease of experimenting with GPT-4 has simplified the entire engineering process.

“Within a day we were able to build a prototype that convinced us this was something we wanted to explore more. It gets us from zero-to-ninety-five percent very quickly. Then we can work manually, hand tuning data to get the last five percent,” he says.

Now his team focuses more on testing and honing data sets.

“It’s definitely changed our engineering process internally. And the features we’ve put together have come out faster than they would have before GPT-4.”

Bill Peterson, Lead Engineer, Duolingo

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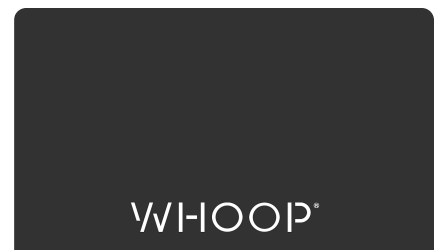
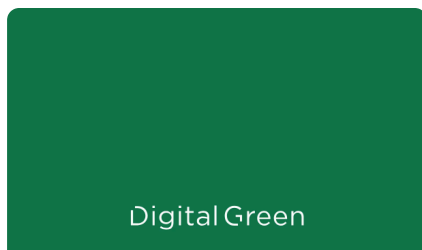
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